

An overview for CPAs & bookkeepers — preparing US rental real estate returns

What it does: takes a client's **trial balance** and turns it into a clean, categorized file that **imports straight into UltraTax CS** — automatically assigning each account the correct tax code, with the preparer reviewing everything first.

How it works — 6 steps

1. **Upload the trial balance** (Excel or CSV). It's processed on your computer — not uploaded anywhere.
2. **Confirm the columns** — it auto-detects the account number, account name, and debit/credit (or balance).
3. **Choose the return type** (1065, 1120-S, 1120, or 1040 Sch E) and review the tax lines & codes.
4. **Auto-categorize** — instant keyword mapping, with optional AI for anything left over.
5. **Review & correct** — editable table; uncertain rows highlighted; live in-balance check.
6. **Export** — one clean sheet ready to import into UltraTax CS.

What's built in

- Official **UltraTax tax codes** for Form 8825, Schedule L & Schedule E.
- Smart **whole-word** matching that picks the most specific code (no false matches).
- **Flags** ambiguous or uncertain accounts instead of guessing silently.
- Color-coded confidence + an **audit note** explaining every account.
- **Trial-balance check** (debits = credits) and a return summary.
- Handles **excluded** accounts and blanks anything left unassigned.
- Fully **customizable** tax lines & keywords — save and reuse your firm's setup.

Your data stays protected

- **Client data stays on your computer** — the trial balance file is never uploaded.
- **AI is optional**; if turned on, it sends only account names/descriptions — **never amounts, balances, or account numbers** — and warns you first.
- **You review and approve everything**. Every code is editable. It's a categorization aid — **not tax advice**; the preparer signs the return.
- **Confirm tax codes** against your UltraTax version, since Thomson Reuters revises them over time.

Good to know

- Pre-loaded for **rental real estate** entities — easy to add other lines.
- **Depreciation** is often computed by UltraTax's asset module — import the book figure or exclude those accounts, your call.
- Reads **Excel/CSV** trial balances (not PDFs) — ask clients for the spreadsheet export.